

This was the case for me and Postmates as well. Postmates workers are given a time limit during which they have to deliver their order (usually thirty minutes). Once I was stopped for photos and almost missed my delivery window, which would have meant I wasn't going to get paid. But how could I explain to an excited fan on the street that I was in a rush? As I say in the piece, "Many famous social media stars are too visible to have 'real' jobs, but too broke not to."

This was the cost of my risky decision to leave BuzzFeed (a steady paycheck) for the great unknown.

A month after we quit, Allison and I got a big break: We sold a half-hour comedy to MTV, and our careers kept advancing. But the sale was for very little money, and the show didn't get past the pilot. (Sometimes a network will shoot thirty pilots and only send three to series. It's a crapshoot.)

But after that sale, we were able to then sell a TV show to FX in 2016, and this one went for a significantly larger amount of money: \$50,000 aka the money that changed my life. It was the most money I'd ever seen. I wasn't even sure my bank account could handle it, so I called and asked. I would not have been able to continue to survive in LA if this script sale had not happened. I used it on a couple of trips to see my family in Florida; to completely pay off a car loan, my dental debt, and two of my smaller student loans; and to pay down one way-overused credit card. I also put some into a retirement fund.

But that FX show didn't get made either. (You still get paid for shows that don't go. This whole industry is super weird.) After that, we sold YET ANOTHER television show, this time to YouTube Red, YouTube's subscription service, though for way less money than the FX show. It did not get made either. (Don't feel badly for us. *You're the Worst* creator Stephen Falk once told us that he sold nine shows before he got anything on the air.) That smaller amount went into retirement, savings, and toward another maxed-out credit card.

Allison and I have made most of our money selling these unaired shows. I also get paid to host my podcast, *Bad with Money*, through ads placed on the show (similar to Google AdSense income) which I split fifty-fifty with the podcast network.